

COMP1004 Computing Project

40 CREDIT MODULE

**ASSESSMENT: 80% Coursework
20% Practice**

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MODULE AIMS

- To familiarise students with the software development lifecycle.
- To develop techniques to elicit requirements from abstract problems.
- To expose students to both technical and non-technical skills required to complete a software engineering project.

ASSESSED LEARNING OUTCOMES (ALO):

1. Articulate the phases of the software development lifecycle.
2. Define suitable functional and non-functional requirements that when implemented in software will solve a given problem.
3. Identify and describe operational considerations of software, including the physical systems upon which they reside, cyber security and networking.
4. Implement a system that fulfils a design specification to solve a given problem.
5. Identify and discuss trade-offs in requirements analysis and production of software versus operational considerations such as time and cost.

OVERVIEW

This document provides information regarding the assessment requirements for the *COMP1004 Computing Practice* module.

For this module, you will apply the complete software development lifecycle to a given problem. Students should choose to apply themselves to the topic area related to their degree. They may write a game, focus on a security problem, or consider an application of artificial intelligence. Security students must focus on Security-related topics.

The module is assessed via two elements: 80% coursework and 20% practice. You must achieve an overall module grade of 40% to pass the module.

This is an **individual** piece of work.

COURSEWORK 01 (CW1) – Product and Report 80%

This part of the assessment scrutinizes the quality of your product, project planning, report content, and critical reflection.

Marks will be based on the report content, the final code/product submission, and the supervisor's experience of you working on your project. Details can be found in the marking rubric.

PRACTICE 01 (PW1) – Poster, Viva & Video 20%

This part of the assessment scrutinizes your ability to present your work in various forms: as a poster, a video, your report, and by your performance in the viva.

Marks will be based on the representative aspects of your portfolio and presentations. Details can be found in the marking rubric.

Assessment Overview

The sections that follow detail the assessment tasks that are to be undertaken. All parts of the project portfolio are to be submitted electronically via the module PebblePad eportfolio before the stated deadlines. Instructions on how to access PebblePad are provided in the '*How to access the PebblePad ePortfolio*' document on the DLE under the assessments tab. Please check the DLE dates.

Portfolio is split into two key phases, Initiation phase and final phase. The initiation phase makes up 30% of your practice marks for the module and consists of a video detailing your project development so far. The final phase makes up 100% of the coursework marks and the remaining 70% of your practice marks. This includes a final report, code base and a project showcase.

The assessment requirements will be presented during the lectures to provide further clarity over what is expected and how you can access support and feedback.

Description	Submission Deadline	Feedback
1 Project Initiation	During scheduled stand-up meetings	
2 Mid Project Review	15 th of January 15:00	12 th February 2026
3 Project ePortfolio Complete	30 th of April 15:00	28 th of May 2026
4 Viva	12 th of May 2026 (9.00-17.00)	28 th of May 2026

Table 1: Assessment Deadlines

This project requires the delivery of a portfolio of work. The portfolio comprises a set of 4 phases with different deliverables, including: links to your version-controlled repository containing your code, a link to your Video Demo of the project in action and reflections from various CPD activities. More details for these deliverables are detailed in the remainder of this document and the PebblePad ePortfolio. Once completed and submitted by the deadline given above the portfolio will be scrutinised in a Viva.

Further details of the deliverables are provided below.

Moderation

This assignment brief has been moderated in line with the university policy.

Moderator Name	Moderation Date
Rory Hopcraft	1 st October 2025

Acceptable level of generative AI tool use in this assessment element

The acceptable level of GenAI use for this coursework is detailed with the allowed uses listed below. This is split into three categories (**Solo Work** – work must be your own with no AI support, **Assisted Work** – some uses of AI tools allowed, **Partnered Work** – AI tools integral part of the work). If you have any questions, please contact the module leader.

Solo Work	You must not use generative AI tools.	☐
Assisted Work	You are permitted to use generative AI tools in an assistive role.	☒
Partnered Work	Generative AI tool use is required as an integral part of the assessment, but transparency is required.	☐

Table 2: Acceptable Level of generative AI use

Inline with the indicated acceptable level of AI use above, the following uses are acceptable:

- **A1 – Idea Generation and Problem Exploration**
- **A2 - Planning & Structuring Projects**
- **A4 – Research Assistance**
- **A5 - Language Refinement**

Any use of AI in your work must be declared within your documentation. You **must also include a signed Generative AI Declaration as an appendix to your submission**. The declaration form can be found on the module DLE. This form will not be included in any word count associated with this assignment.

Useful Assignment Information

Please see below some useful information regarding submissions for your modules.

Good Coding Practices

Like all things, no code is perfect. Just because your code compiles and runs does not mean it is perfect, there is always room for improvement. No code will achieve 100% of the available marks. Where code submission is required by a module, it will be assessed against the following criteria:

1) Functionality

- a. Does your code meet all the specified requirements of the assignment?
- b. Does your code behave correctly across typical and edge-case scenarios?
- c. Does your code have appropriate error handling that does not lead to it crashing or undefined behaviour?

2) Efficiency

- a. Is your code optimised in terms of performance and resource use?
- b. Does your code handle functions, variables, data calls efficiently?
- c. Is there any unnecessary repetition, complexity or processing reducing efficiency within your code?

3) Readability

- a. Is your code logically structured and easy to read?
- b. Have you maintained standard formatting conventions like indentations, spacing and naming, within your code?
- c. Are variables, functions, and classes clearly named and purposeful?

4) Documentation

- a. Are there helpful comments explaining non-obvious parts of your code?
- b. Do your comments document your process, development or rationale clearly?
- c. Could someone unfamiliar with the code understand the approach you have taken?

Use of Generative AI for Creating Code

Each assignment element for each module will have a clear indication of the permitted level of use of AI (solo, assisted or partnered) including the generation of code. Please ensure that you **read and understand the permitted use**. If you are unsure of a particular use, please reach out to the Module Leader and ask.

We strongly encourage you to read and explore beyond the core content delivered within the modules. However, this must be done correctly following academic process. Wherever code is drawn from an outside source (e.g. you have not written it yourself), regardless of whether this is AI generated or from an online repository (GitHub, Stack Overflow etc) **you must reference the original source**. This can be done in your documentation as comments or part of your write ups. Students found to be utilising code without referencing could face an academic offence. **If in doubt speak to your Module Leader.**

Versioning

A critical part of a development (software or academic) is versioning. Keeping a number of iterations over the course of development ensures you always have backups to fall back on. It also provides clear demonstration of the development process you implemented.

Using online/cloud-based storage solutions and repositories provide additional peace of mind, alongside being industry practice. The university provide OneDrive to all students which offers

inbuilt version history for Microsoft products. GitHub is the university recommended repository for versioning code, which includes great integration with a number of IDEs.

Submitting Code

It is vital that you confirm that all code that you submit is in the **correct format** and **compiles correctly** or **runs without error**. If you clean up your code before submission, please ensure that all dependencies (libraries, functions and variables) are included so that the marker can compile your code.

We can only mark what has been submitted. If the code does not run correctly, it is not our responsibility to spend time error handling to award you marks.

It is also important to **show your working**. Tidying up your code is a critical part of coding practices, but if you remove the workings that provides you with the required output, we cannot see how you got there.

In a worst-case scenario, if you remove a key part of your working, and on compiling your code it gives an error or different result, we have no way of confirming what went wrong, or indeed if you fabricated those outputs.

Please note, just because a piece of code has given the wrong output, it does not mean it should be deleted. Seeing these attempts with comments documenting your attempt allows us to understand where you may have made an error and provide feedback that addresses this. In some cases, you could also be awarded marks for the attempt

Phase 1: Project Initiation

Task:

During the first semester of the module, you have the opportunity to formulate your own ideas for your Single Page Application (SPA) project, supported by your stand-up meeting leader (you will be informed about this soon). Check out the [description of a SPA here](#). Phase 1 is not assessed.

You should identify the point and purpose of your project. This will require you to think of a title and work up a project scope. Please do not consider your project title and project vision as fixed – they can change as you develop your ideas. However, you need to know at the start roughly where you want to develop your ideas. By ensuring you start with a coherent project title and project scope, you can ensure you start in an organised fashion.

Indicative scenarios can be found on the ePortfolio under the page entitled “Indicative Scenarios”. Each scenario has an indicated base functionality, and an initial task is to research the background to the project and to develop that functionality further. You need to analyse, design and develop a prototype of moderate complexity and deliver a complete software solution.

You **must only** use technologies that you have learnt during this module! These are listed on the ePortfolio under the page entitled “Allowed Technologies List”.

You should use appropriate project management tools such as a planner (e.g., Microsoft Planner) and a diary. Being able to use a diary and control your time is an essential part of being a professional.

Students need to use a GitHub repository. Edit the readme.md file so that your project title, vision and stand-up meeting leader are clearly noted. Make sure the name of the repository reflects your name.

This is the stage where you must also give some consideration as to the potential for things to go wrong. Please read around the topic matter and identify what pertinent risks there might be to your project. Once you have identified what could go wrong, you need to consider the likelihood of that happening and what you will do about it. Any risks that have a high likelihood and a high impact **MUST** have actions identified to prevent them should the events happen.

ePortfolio Evidence:

- a. Complete Section “1. Project Initiation” on ePortfolio containing:
 - ⇒ Stand-up Meeting Leader
 - ⇒ Project Title
 - ⇒ Project Scope (250 words)
 - ⇒ Project Requirements (3-5 requirements)
 - ⇒ Project Plan

Phase 2: Mid Project Review

Task:

The aim of this submission is to present and demonstrate via a video of what you have done so far and demonstrate a basic functioning prototype. The information included in your video should reflect the ePortfolio sections 1 and 2.

In the video you have 5 minutes and must present the following in this exact order:

1. The project vision and background
2. Your project plan and sprints so far
3. UML models so far
4. An initial prototype running
5. Issues/challenges faced

You are advised to use Microsoft PowerPoint to create slides that you can talk around during your video. E.g. screenshots, images etc. You can use Panopto, Zoom or Teams to record your video if needed. The video should then be uploaded to the ePortfolio. Please ensure your video plays once uploaded.

You must not speed up your video to gain more time. Note that your video will be paused for thorough reading, so always show each slide for at least 10 seconds.

Show only the slides and your application running. You should not record yourself on your webcam or any other background. Please remember to narrate what you are showing, it is not supposed to be a silent movie. Also, please do not read straight from your slides. Just explain what it is you are showing me on the current screen.

The video is worth 30% of your overall practice mark.

You will also have attended sessions regarding Careers and Project Communication, as part of the mid-project review, you need to reflect on these sessions and how they have influenced your approach to this project.

The marking criteria for this element are outlined in Table 2.

ePortfolio Evidence:

- a. Updated Section "1. Project Initiation"
- b. Complete Section "2. Mid Project Review" on ePortfolio containing:
 - ⇒ Interim Video (maximum of 5 minutes in length)
 - ⇒ Professional Development Review (250 words)

Phase 3: Final Portfolio

Task:

This deliverable (final portfolio) accounts for 100% of your coursework mark.

To complete your project, you must finalise your project title, project vision, UML diagrams, document the development, and produce a poster.

For the design document, use the provided template (see **Template.pdf** under the Assessments tab). To achieve full marks, your document must include all the sections outlined in the template. The key sections are as follows:

- **Project Plan Representation:** This should illustrate your backlog and sprints.
- **UML Diagrams:** A complete set of UML diagrams to represent your application.
- **Reflective Account:** Approximately 500 words reflecting on the issues and challenges encountered during the project.
- **GitHub Link:** Be sure to include a link to a public GitHub repository. While starting with a private repository is recommended, ensure it is made public when you submit your coursework. If the repository remains private, markers will be unable to assess your code, leading to a significant loss of marks. The README file should provide an overview of your project.

Under the Assessments tab, you will also find design documents from previous years. These examples are intended to help you understand the submission requirements, but they do not necessarily represent best practices.

The poster should be based on your project vision and provide the reader with a glimpse into how you are applying the technology to solve the problem you have identified. The purpose of the poster is to provide enough information so that somebody can understand what your project is about and an indication as to how you are putting your software together. It does NOT require you to have completed your software.

You can use any software you wish to make the poster, including PowerPoint. Templates and instructions for creating posters can be found under the assessments tab on the COMP1004 DLE page.

Your final project ePortfolio will consist of a number of items detailed below.

1. A 250-word reflection of an CPD development activity you attended during the year. This should be external to the sessions delivered during the course of COMP1004. Some examples of activities for this section include (but are not limited to) guest lectures, LinkedIn learning, online webinars/seminars. You should include what you learned from the event and how they have made you think/work differently. You are encouraged to reflect on how these could develop your work.
2. A 3,000-word-report documenting your project and the processes that supported the development of your project. This includes a 500-word reflective review on the issues and

challenges you faced during your project. This is a substantial piece of writing that should be drafted, redrafted and worked on over a period of time, not left until the last minute.

3. A complete set of your final UML diagrams to represent your application.
4. A version-controlled repository with organised code and an informative README. Your report submission must contain a link to your repository. Obviously, your code should work for high marks.
5. A poster illustrating the key features of your project.
6. Complete and upload the AI declaration form and Marketing Materials usage declaration.

The marking criteria for this element are outlined in Table 3.

ePortfolio Evidence:

- a. Link to version-controlled repository
- b. Final poster
- c. Complete UML diagrams
- d. 3,000 word report
- e. Summary of CPD activities and reflections (500 words)

Phase 4: Project Viva

Task:

The final part of the module is a project viva that will take a maximum of 6 minutes.

Within the 6 minutes you must present the following, in this exact order:

1. Briefly introduce your project.
2. Run your application.
3. Briefly go through your source code and explain how you implemented it.
4. High level summary of Issues and challenges faced.
5. Show your poster. For more information about how to make the poster see the '**Poster Samples and Instructions**' folder under the assessment tab, on the module's DLE page.

During this session, you should have your application running on your laptop or on a lab PC and your poster to present to two examiners. During this time, you will be asked questions about your code, its development and the SDLC. If you exceed the 6 minutes you will be stopped and marked based on what you presented in the 6 minutes slot.

This deliverable accounts for 70% of your overall practice mark.

The marking criteria for this element are outlined in Table 4.

ePortfolio Evidence:

- a. No ePortfolio requirements

MARKING CRITERIA: Mid Project Review – Video Submission (30% of overall Practice mark)

	Level descriptors. <i>Note that these definitions are indicative of expected standards at each level, and may not be precise descriptors of the project submitted.</i>						
Category and marks weighting:	<30%	30-39%	40-49%	50-59%	60-69%	70-79%	80-100%
Planning (15%) Planning; define the application and what the application will do. Sprint plans appear appropriate to meet aims of project. Details presented should reflect the contents of the portfolio.	Little/no evidence of having prepared or followed a structured project plan.	Inadequate project planning; tasks vague &/or illogically planned.	Some project planning and logic, but needs much more thought, detail &/or clarity.	The project was mostly well planned & managed. Some questionable logic &/or may lack detail.	The project was generally well planned and managed.	Clear and logical project planning; dynamic response to setbacks/new discoveries.	Professional project management throughout all stages of the project.
Project vision and background (15%) Details presented should reflect the contents of the portfolio.	Little or no discussion regarding project vision and background.	The project vision and background are superficial and lacking in structure.	Project vision and background communicated ok, but the format could be improved.	Project vision and background are described well overall, but with some errors or omissions.	Project vision and background are good, clearly communicated and well-articulated.	Project vision and background as previously, but with excellent justification, with clear evidence of understanding the context.	Project vision and background are clear, precise, and meaningful, with excellent understanding of the background demonstrated.
Requirement Analysis and Design (35%) Define the requirements, user stories and UML diagrams. Details presented should reflect the contents of the portfolio.	Images/graphs/figs are sparse, illegible &/or irrelevant.	Images/graphs/figs do not convey the required information.	Most images/graphs/figs convey the required information but may lack clarity &/or contain errors.	Mainly appropriate images/graphs/figs - aesthetics &/or labelling could improve.	Most images/graphs/figs of high standard; occasional minor errors/issues.	Images/graphs/figs of high standard, clearly conveying all required information. Architecture has good complexity.	Excellent images/graphs/figs.
Communication of information and Issues/challenges faced (20%) The presentation should be pitched at an audience that is scientifically literate, but non-expert in this particular subject specialism.	Little/no explanation of what was done over the course of the project.	The explanation provides little insight into what was done over the course of the project.	Some explanation of what was done - rather vague/confusing.	A useful explanation of what was done - clarity could improve.	A clear explanation of what was done over the course of the project.	A clear, concise and informative explanation of what was done.	Explanation clearly conveys technically demanding project work to a non-expert audience.

Demonstration and Professionalism (15%) Verbal presentation of the project (what you did, why, and what you discovered). Engaging with the project and demonstrating the appropriate professionalism skills of a developer/researcher. Including Continued Professional Development (CPD). Demonstrating these skills include: • Engagement with supervision process • Attending the Showcase and other project events Being punctual to project events • Required ePortfolio sections completed	Little/no ability to verbally communicate technical information.	Inadequate verbal communication of technical information.	Verbal communication of technical information is very difficult to follow.	Mostly effective verbal communication of relevant concepts/outcomes.	Good verbal communication of relevant concepts/outcomes.	Clear and eloquent verbal presentation of relevant concepts/outcomes	Expert verbal communication ; concepts/outcomes pitched at the right audience level.
	Rare or no engagement with the supervision process. Failure to attend other project events.	Limited engagement with the supervision process. Turning up late to other project events.	Minimal but consistent engagement with supervision, with minimal response to feedback. Attend the majority of events with some participation.	Regular engagement with the supervision process. Attends most project events and is generally punctual.	Regular and proactive engagement with supervision. Attends project events with active participation.	Strong and proactive engagement with supervision, seeking and applying feedback. Well-prepared for events and makes clear, positive contributions.	Excellent, proactive and consistent engagement with supervision, actively seeking and applying feedback. Attends all events, takes leadership and plays a highly active role.

Table 2: Marking Criteria for Mid Project Review

MARKING CRITERIA: Final ePortfolio – (100% of overall Coursework mark)

	Level descriptors. <i>Note that these definitions are indicative of expected standards at each level, and may not be precise descriptors of the project submitted.</i>						
Category and marks weighting:	<30%	30-39%	40-49%	50-59%	60-69%	70-79%	80-100%
Plans (15%) Structured project plan for complete project produced. Sprint plans map to backlog and aims. Releases made every two weeks with appropriate plans and reviews.	Application to SDLC is totally unclear, undefined &/or irrelevant.	Inadequate SDLC definition; very poorly defined.	SDLC definition underdeveloped, vague &/or illogical.	SDLC clarity &/or validity could improve.	Clear and sensibly defined SDLC.	SDLC is very well defined, explained and justified. Evidence of reading beyond module materials provided.	Perfect SDLC definition showing understanding and reading beyond the taught materials; clear link to the plan showing stages.
	Little/no evidence of having prepared or followed a structured project plan.	Inadequate project planning; tasks vague &/or illogically planned.	Some project planning and logic, but needs much more thought, detail &/or clarity.	The project was mostly well planned & managed. Some questionable logic &/or may lack detail. Prototyping sprints are in place.	The project is generally well planned and managed. Clear evidence of prototyping sprints being implemented.	Clear and logical project planning; dynamic response to setbacks/new discoveries. All sprints are carefully planned. Clear evidence of sprint plans and reviews.	Strong project management throughout all stages of the project was clearly demonstrated.
Requirements (25%) Backlog shows how requirements are finally realised. Implementation of agile artefacts matches the proposed plans, deviation from plan discussed appropriately. Little or no discussion regarding project vision Project vision superficial and lacking in structure Project vision	Little or no discussion regarding project vision.	The project vision is superficial and lacking in structure.	Project vision is communicated ok, but the format could be improved.	The project vision is described well overall, but with some errors or omissions.	Project vision is good, clearly communicated and well-articulated.	Project vision as previously, but with excellent justification, with clear evidence of understanding the context.	Project vision is clear, precise, and meaningful, with excellent understanding of the background demonstrated.

communicate d ok but format could be improved Project vision described well overall but with some errors or omissions Project vision good, clearly communicate d and well articulated Project vision as previous but with excellent justification with clear evidence of understanding context Project vision clear, precise, meaningful with excellent understanding of background demonstrated Design documentation illustrates functional and non-functional requirements of final project. Diagrams clearly match the code implemented in all sprints. Design documentation shows the existing prototype implementation.	Little or no indication of requirements.	Requirements are present but vague and poorly defined. Diagrams not provided.	Requirements are present but need more thought and development. Few diagrams are present, but a lack of understanding is demonstrated.	Requirements presented ok with appropriate diagrams. Some questionable logic was demonstrated. Some errors and omissions.	Requirements are clear and sensibly defined. Requirements appropriate for the complexity of the project. Coverage of the application is appropriate.	Requirements have a good depth of coverage for the application. Diagrams are clearly derived from requirements.	Requirements are excellent with little further to add. Diagrams match with requirements and could be used in a professional setting.
	Little or no indication of requirements having been implemented.	Requirements shown as implemented in sprints are inconsequential .	Requirements shown as implemented, but the illustration is not clear and lacks clarity.	Requirements matched to implementation in sprints, some errors and omissions.	Requirements matched to implementation are appropriate for all sprints.	Requirements matched to implementation are clearly indicative of a minimum viable product for sprints.	Requirements matched to implementation are of professional standard.
Issues (30%) Consideration given to any changes in constraints of the physical system, cybersecurity and network as identified earlier. Showing a clear understanding of relevant subject matter throughout the project. Any changes to Legal, Social, Ethical and Professional issues are clearly and appropriately discussed along with appropriate critical comment and authoritative citations.	Absent/irrelevant issues.	Inadequate/unjustified issues.	Issues are vague and/or largely unjustified.	Relevant issues. Accuracy, evidence &/or clarity could improve.	Logical issues are predominantly evidence-based and clearly presented.	Appropriate, well-presented and well-justified issues.	Clear, concise and fully quantitatively justified issues.
	Absent/irrelevant constraints.	Inadequate/unjustified constraints.	Constraints vague and/or largely unjustified.	Relevant constraints. Accuracy, evidence &/or clarity could improve.	Logical constraints are predominantly evidence-based and clearly presented.	Appropriate, well-presented and well-justified constraints.	Clear, concise and fully quantitatively justified constraints.
	Missing/irrelevant list of references. Absence of valid citations throughout the report.	Superficial reference list &/or predominantly incorrect/inadequate citations.	Reference list present. Major presentation issues &/or poor citation style.	Reference list &/or citations could be more clearly/correctly presented.	Most citations & reference list entries are correctly presented; some minor issues.	Highly competent use of citations and reference list.	Extensive list of references & citation style: peer-reviewed journal standard.

	Little or no evidence of understanding of appropriate LSEP issues.	Inadequate understanding of relevant LSEP issues. Vague mentions made with little demonstrable understanding.	Some understanding of LSEP issues with errors &/or a poor conceptual framework.	Reasonable understanding of LSEP issues; minor errors. May require more depth.	Good understanding of LSEP issues with a clear conceptual framework.	Excellent understanding of LSEP issues beyond the level of taught modules.	Expert understanding of LSEP issues with rigorous attention to relevant detail.
Implementation (30%) Evidence of appropriate implementation for a 40-credit module. Demonstration of skill in implementation. Implementation of agile artefacts match proposed plans, deviations from the plan are discussed appropriately. Implementation of code at the appropriate level with demonstration of good software engineering principles such as DRY, YAGNI and SOLID.	Little or no evidence of coding skills in project implementation .	Poor skills in implementing code - incorrect &/or very confused.	Some skill in implementing the software, but with errors &/or confusion. The application provides more functionality than login and registration.	Skill in most areas of software implementation - some issues/errors. Implementation of moderate complexity with suitable functionality demonstrated.	Competent implementation of software with minor issues/errors. Application is of suitable complexity, has appropriate storage for any data, and architecture is not monolithic but demonstrates interactions between levels and/or layers of software.	Highly skilled implementation of software (far beyond the level of taught modules). The application has good complexity and shows good quality software engineering. Data storage, if required, is good; the application goes way beyond a form of data storage with front front-end.	Expert level of skill in all relevant areas is clearly evident throughout. Software is of commercial quality and could be implemented in real real-world situation with very little modification.
	Little or no evidence of relevant skills in project implementation .	Poor skills in implementing the methodology - incorrect &/or very confused.	Some skill in implementing the methodology, but with errors &/or confusion.	Skill in most areas of methodology implementation - some issues/errors.	Competent implementation of methodology with minor issues/errors.	Highly skilled implementation of methodology (far beyond the level of taught modules).	Expert level of skill in all relevant areas is clearly evident throughout.

	Little or no relevant work done to achieve project aims & objectives.	Minimal relevant work done to achieve project aims & objectives.	Some relevant work, but far short of that expected in the time allocated for 40 credits.	Project engagement &/or depth of coverage of the task could improve.	Good project engagement and coverage of the task.	Good depth of coverage of the task, showing a high level of project engagement.	Comprehensive coverage of a highly demanding task. Very high level of engagement.
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Table 3: Marking criteria for final portfolio

Level descriptors. *Note that these definitions are indicative of expected standards at each level, and may not be precise descriptors of the project submitted.*

Category and marks weighting:	<40%	40-49%	50-59%	60-69%	>70%
Prototype Running (25%)	Software does not run.	Software runs but with bugs/issues.	Software runs properly without bugs or issues.	Software contains advanced features.	Software at a professional level.
Planning (15%) Define the application and what the application will do.	Inadequate project planning; tasks vague &/or illogically planned.	Some project planning and logic but needs much more thought, detail &/or clarity.	Project mostly well planned & managed. Some questionable logic.	Project generally well planned and managed.	Strong project management throughout all stages of the project clearly demonstrated
Communication of information and Issues/challenges faced (20%) The presentation should be pitched at an audience that is scientifically literate, but nonexpert in this particular subject specialism.	Explanation provides little insight into what was done over the course of the project.	Some explanation of what was done - rather vague/confusing.	A useful explanation of what was done - clarity could improve.	A clear explanation of what was done over the course of the project.	Explanation clearly conveys technically demanding project work to non-expert audience.
Poster structure & aesthetics (10%) The poster should deliver information in a clear, logical order. It should be aesthetically pleasing and visually exciting. It should not appear too cluttered, but also not too sparse, with a good balance of text and images (such as pictures, graphs, formulae, etc).	No thought given to poster structure or aesthetics.	Poster is not very attractively presented - may be rather messy &/or poorly structured.	Poster is reasonably visually appealing. Might lack some structure &/or tidiness.	Good poster structure and aesthetics.	Poster is effective, attractive and exciting. Very well thought out structure.
Viva (20%) Verbal presentation of the project (what you did, why, and what you discovered). Your response to the moderator's questions should demonstrate a deep understanding of the subject matter and the implications of your results.	Inadequate verbal communication of technical information. Vague, very confused &/or factually incorrect response to moderator's questions.	Verbal communication of technical information is very difficult to follow. Response to moderator's questions shows limited grasp of necessary concepts.	Mostly effective verbal communication of relevant concepts/outcomes. Some sensible responses to moderator's questions - a bit naive &/or lacking depth.	Good verbal communication of relevant concepts/outcomes. Mostly clear, sensible responses to moderator's questions.	Expert verbal communication; concepts/outcomes pitched at the right audience level. Comprehensive, expert response to moderator's questions.

Professionalism (10%) Engaging with the project and demonstrating the appropriate professional skills of a developer/researcher. Including Continued Professional Development (CPD). Demonstrating these skills includes: • Engagement with the supervision process • Attending other project events • Being punctual for project events	Rare or no engagement with the supervision process. Failure to attend other project events.	Minimal but consistent engagement with supervision, with minimal response to feedback. Attend the majority of events with some participation.	Regular engagement with the supervision process. Attends most project events and is generally punctual.	Regular and proactive engagement with supervision. Attends project events with active participation.	Strong and proactive engagement with supervision, seeking and applying feedback. Well-prepared for events and makes clear, positive contributions.
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Table 4: Marking criteria for the viva

Acceptable levels of AI use:

The table below provides the acceptable use categories for GenAI. Each assessment element may allow different uses. Please check the brief for each element carefully to see what uses are allowed.

Solo Work	S1 - Generative AI tools have not been used for this assessment.
Assisted Work	A1 – Idea Generation and Problem Exploration Used to generate project ideas, explore different approaches to solving a problem, or suggest features for software or systems. Students must critically assess AI-generated suggestions and ensure their own intellectual contributions are central.
	A2 - Planning & Structuring Projects AI may help outline the structure of reports, documentation and projects. The final structure and implementation must be the student's own work.
	A3 – Code Architecture AI tools maybe used to help outline code architecture (e.g. suggesting class hierarchies or module breakdowns). The final code structure must be the student's own work.
	A4 – Research Assistance Used to locate and summarise relevant articles, academic papers, technical documentation, or online resources (e.g. Stack Overflow, GitHub discussions). The interpretation and integration of research into the assignment remain the student's responsibility.
	A5 - Language Refinement Used to check grammar, refine language, improve sentence structure in documentation not code. AI should be used only to provide suggestions for improvement. Students must ensure that the documentation accurately reflects the code and is technically correct.
	A6 – Code Review AI tools can be used to check comments within the code and to suggest improvements to code readability, structure or syntax. AI should be used only to provide suggestions for improvement. Students must ensure that the code accurately reflects their knowledge and is technically correct.
	A7 - Code Generation for Learning Purposes Used to generate example code snippets to understand syntax, explore alternative implementations, or learn new programming paradigms. Students must not submit AI-generated code as their own and must be able to explain how it works.
	A8 - Technical Guidance & Debugging Support AI tools can be used to explain algorithms, programming concepts, or debugging strategies. Students may also help interpret error messages or suggest possible fixes. However, students must write, test, and debug their own code independently and understand all solutions submitted.
	A9 - Testing and Validation Support AI may assist in generating test cases, validating outputs, or suggesting edge cases for software testing. Students are responsible for designing comprehensive test plans and interpreting test results.
	A10 - Data Analysis and Visualization Guidance AI tools can help suggest ways to analyse datasets or visualize results (e.g. recommending chart types or statistical methods). Students must perform the analysis themselves and understand the implications of the results.
	A11 - Other uses not listed above Please specify:
Partnered Work	P1 - Generative AI tool usage has been used integrally for this assessment Students can adopt approaches that are compliant with instructions in the assessment brief. Please Specify:

General Guidance

Extenuating Circumstances

There may be a time during this module where you experience a serious situation which has a significant impact on your ability to complete the assessments. The definition of these can be found in the University Policy on Extenuating Circumstances here:

<https://www.plymouth.ac.uk/student-life/your-studies/essential-information/exams/exam-rules-and-regulations/extenuating-circumstances>

Plagiarism

All of your work must be of your own words. You must use references for your sources, however you acquire them. Where you wish to use quotations, these must be a very minor part of your overall work.

To copy another person's work is viewed as plagiarism and is not allowed. Any issues of plagiarism and any form of academic dishonesty are treated very seriously. All your work must be your own and other sources must be identified as being theirs, not yours. The copying of another persons' work could result in a penalty being invoked.

Further information on plagiarism policy can be found here:

Plagiarism: <https://www.plymouth.ac.uk/student-life/your-studies/essential-information/regulations/plagiarism>

Examination Offences: <https://www.plymouth.ac.uk/student-life/your-studies/essential-information/exams/exam-rules-and-regulations/examination-offences>

Turnitin (<http://www.turnitinuk.com/>) is an Internet-based 'originality checking tool' which allows documents to be compared with content on the Internet, in journals and in an archive of previously submitted works. It can help to detect unintentional or deliberate plagiarism.

It is a formative tool that makes it easy for students to review their citations and referencing as an aid to learning good academic practice. Turnitin produces an 'originality report' to help guide you. To learn more about Turnitin go to:

<https://help.turnitin.com/new-links.htm?Highlight=guide>

The university also had Draft Coach available on the online version of Microsoft Word. Draft Coach is a Turnitin plugin and provides instant feedback on how to address citation issues, grammar mistakes and matches with Turnitin's database.

Referencing

The University of Plymouth Library has produced an online support referencing guide which is available here: <http://plymouth.libguides.com/referencing>

Another recommended referencing resource is [Cite Them Right Online](#); this is an online resource which provides you with specific guidance about how to reference lots of different types of materials.